come. In fact, a lot of their predictions about the future have turned out to be eerily accurate. Some others have obviously failed as technology progressed, but the base ideas of their works are what capture the imagination of any reader.

Not many know that Asimov and Clarke shared a good friendship. The two often met to discuss ideas and the future, unbothered by the world's need to crown one of them as better than the other. Well actually, that's not entirely true. They were quite aware of this and even came up with a small joke in the form of the Asimov-Clarke Treaty of Park Avenue, which they compiled while on a cab ride in Park Avenue, New York. The treaty stated that when asked, Asimov would always insist that Clarke was the best science fiction writer in the world (reserving second best for himself), while Clarke would always maintain that Isaac Asimov was the best science writer in the world (reserving second best for himself). In fact, Clarke dedicated his book *Report on Planet Three to Asimov,* writing, "In accordance with the terms of the Clarke-Asimov treaty, the second-best science writer dedicates this book to the second-best science-fiction writer."

So why was their work so revolutionary and widely appreciated? Even examining a few of their ideas, one comes away with the answer.

Asimov's Positronic Brain

In Isaac Asimov's world of artificially intelligent robots, perhaps no piece of technology has been as important as the "positronic brain". Indeed, so popular was the term that it has since been replicated and reused in several different science fiction franchises. Almost every android in Asimov's robot series of novels is equipped with this computer in their heads.

But the funniest part about the positronic brain is that the technology behind it has never been truly explained. Asimov let through information in little bits and pieces in several different books and stories, but never sat down and explained the machinations of the positronic brain.

In fact, he has publicly stated that the word "positronic" was merely a way of catching people's fancy. A positron is basically the antiparticle or antimatter of the electron. To put it simply, whereas an electron has a charge of -1, a positron has a charge of +1. There's no real science in Asomov's suggestion that such a piece of sophisticated computational machinery would be built using positrons. The only reason he used the term is because the positron was a newly discovered particle when writing the robot stories and he thought the adjective form (positronic, inspired from electronic)